

RACHEL'S LOOP

A Feature Film

Written by J.T. Gurzi

Full Disclosure

About

Tagline:

Some truths don't want to be revealed -- they want to be quietly hidden.

Genre:

Hard Science Fiction / Psychological Drama / Political Thriller (*Conspiracy Thriller*)

Logline:

After her mother is targeted for attempting to expose a covert defense program involving non-human intelligence, a young academic becomes trapped in a temporal loop that forces her to choose between saving her family and allowing the truth to be buried forever.

Rachel's Loop lives where speculative science fiction meets institutional realism.

The Story (Synopsis)

ACT I: *The Discovery*

Rachel, a folklore and mythology student, begins receiving cryptic warnings from her mother, Norma -- a former intelligence asset secretly involved in psionic communication with non-human intelligence. When Norma appears to die from an apparent overdose, Rachel uncovers classified materials suggesting her mother was preparing to expose a powerful defense contractor exploiting extraterrestrial technology.

Rachel's investigation draws unseen attention. Surveillance tightens. Access to information triggers retaliation. Truth is not denied -- it's noticed.

ACT II: *The Loop*

After retrieving a classified device, Rachel encounters a non-human intelligence and awakens to find herself reliving the days before her mother's death. Each loop gives her more insight but comes at a cost -- trust erodes, memories fracture, and the system adapts faster than she can.

Rachel learns the contractor's methods are procedural, repeatable, and lethal. Hawk, her mother's colleague, is silenced in real time, revealing that "overdoses" are a signature, not coincidence. The loop no longer protects Rachel. It exposes her.

ACT III: *Containment*

Rachel succeeds in saving her mother, but only by delivering the evidence into a sealed institutional space. In a SCIF, the truth is authenticated and archived. Disclosure is delayed, diluted, and neutralized.

Norma survives. The truth survives. History does not change.

The film ends not with revelation, but with coexistence -- a world that continues, unaware, while those who know the truth learn to live differently within it.



The Characters

Rachel Waite (early 20's)

Role:

Protagonist

Type:

Intelligent, emotionally contained, quietly resilient

Backstory:

Raised by a mother who valued ethics over comfort, Rachel lives in the space between myth and scholarship. She witnessed her father, a government analyst, quietly lose his career after reporting internal misconduct -- a lesson that taught her that truth can be erased without confrontation. Her academic interest in angels and non-human intermediaries mirrors her own transformation -- from observer of ancient truths to a custodian of modern ones.

Arc:

From idealistic seeker to ethical realist, to silent carrier of truth.

Casting Note:

An actress capable of interior performance; strength without grandiosity.

Norma Waite (50's-60's)

Role:

Mother / Whistleblower / Psionic Specialist

Backstory:

A former intelligence asset recruited for her psionic sensitivity; Norma spent decades operating within classified programs and has most recently realized her work is enabling exploitation rather than understanding.

Arc:

From believer in institutional reform, to moral dissident, to protected but constrained survivor.

Casting Note:

Warmth and authority. A presence that suggests depth without exposition.

Tawodi “Hawk” (50’s–60’s)

Role:

Moral Axis / Sacrificial Figure

Backstory:

A former intelligence insider with an Indigenous spiritual grounding. Hawk quietly withdrew after witnessing how discovery is routinely exploited and contained, choosing ethical stewardship over institutional advantage. His wisdom comes not from idealism, but from having survived long enough to know when speaking costs more than silence. Hawk understands the cost of disclosure long before others do.

Arc:

From mentor, to liability, to evidence of the system’s methods.

Casting Note:

Spiritual gravity. Someone whose death changes the temperature of the film.

James Waite (20's-30's)

Role:

Brother / Civilian Perspective

Backstory:

Emotionally distant, skeptical, grounded in normalcy. James represents the world that disclosure would disrupt.

Arc:

From dismissive skeptic, to wounded witness, to someone who understands but loses something in the process.

The Antagonists

Who:

Contractors / Agents

Role:

Systemic Force

Note:

These characters are intentionally underwritten psychologically. They are calm, professional, procedural. Their menace comes from *normalcy*.

Filmmaker Statement

Director's Statement

Rachel's Loop is not about disclosure. It's about what happens to people who carry truths that institutions are not prepared to metabolize.

At its surface, the story engages with non-human intelligence, covert programs, and the modern mythology surrounding UAPs (UFOs) and secrecy. But those elements are not the engine of the film -- they're the pressure system. The true subject is custodianship -- who's permitted to know, who decides when knowledge moves, and what it costs to live with information that must be contained rather than released.

From the beginning, this world treats truth as something that is handled, logged, secured, and archived. Knowledge is never free. It's always mediated by procedure. This is intentional. The antagonistic force in the story is not a single villain or agency, but a systemic reflex -- a structure that does not rage or gloat, but quietly absorbs disruption to preserve continuity.

The private defense contractor, the intelligence apparatus, and the bureaucratic response to revelation are not portrayed as cartoonishly evil. They are calm, professional, and convinced of their necessity. Their violence is procedural, not emotional. This restraint is essential. The film rejects spectacle in favor of administrative dread -- the unsettling realization that the most consequential acts often occur without raised voices or visible cruelty.

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Director's Statement (continued)

Rachel's journey is not a heroic ascent toward triumph. It's an education in limits. Early in the story, knowledge feels empowering -- almost benevolent. Over time, it becomes clear that repetition creates visibility, visibility creates risk, and risk invites containment. The temporal loop is not a gift; it's a pressure cooker. Each return costs her something -- trust, certainty, innocence; until she understands the true shape of the system she's moving within.

By the final act, disclosure is no longer framed as a moral absolute. It's a calculation. The question is no longer "*Should the truth be told?*" but "*What will be lost by telling the truth?*" The answer our story arrives at is intentionally uncomfortable -- some truths can be preserved without being liberated; some lives can be saved only if history remains unchanged. The Sensitive Compartmented Information Facility (SCIF) is not a place of resolution. It's the logical endpoint of a world that manages disruption by converting it into records. When the truth is accepted there, it's not denied -- it's archived. This distinction matters. The film's ending is not cynical, but sober. Survival is possible. Justice, in the classical sense, is not.

The final moments return us to ordinary human behavior -- music, movement, connection -- not as celebration, but as coexistence with unresolved knowledge. Life continues. Meaning persists. But something fundamental has shifted. The characters who know the truth must now live differently within a world that does not. The non-human intelligence is not here to save us or judge us. It observes. It waits. The moral test belongs entirely to humanity.

Rachel's Loop is about adulthood -- not as age, but as ethical posture. It asks the audience to sit with the possibility that truth does not always arrive as liberation, and that sometimes the most responsible act is not revelation but bearing the weight of knowing.

Themes

Themes

- Custodianship of dangerous knowledge
- Truth vs. timing
- Institutional containment
- Moral adulthood
- Observation without intervention
- Survival without justice

Tone

Tone

A grounded science-fiction thriller with a philosophical core.

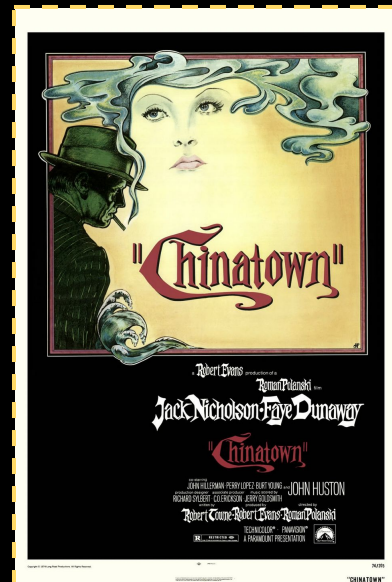
Restrained. Quietly devastating.

Tonal Comps

<i>Arrival</i>	Emotional intelligence, time as consequence
<i>Contact</i>	Faith vs. proof, institutional skepticism
<i>Chinatown</i>	Systemic power, irreversible loss

Rachel's Loop sits between *Arrival*'s intimacy and *Chinatown*'s refusal of justice.

If *Arrival* asks, “Would you choose love knowing it ends?” Then, *Rachel's Loop* asks, “Would you protect the truth knowing no one will know?”



Visual and Tonal Approach

- Grounded in an observational camera language.
- Minimal spectacle, maximum implication.
- Violence is procedural, not sensational.
- Technology is utilitarian, not futuristic.
- Repetition without comfort.

Pacing: Deliberate escalation.

Production Scope

Production Scope

- Contained locations.
- Small ensemble cast.
- Minimal VFX.
- Prestige-drama scale.

Rachel's Loop is designed to be achievable and durable.

What & Why

What Makes Rachel's Loop Distinct

- Antagonists as systems, not villains.
- Violence as procedure, not spectacle.
- Temporal mechanics (time) as pressure, not puzzle.
- Disclosure as burden, not triumph.
- A final act that refuses reassurance.

Rachel's Loop is a sci-fi thriller for adults.

Why This Story Can Only Be Told This Way

This story can't be a conventional thriller without betraying its core idea.

If the truth is revealed publicly:

- The film becomes a fantasy.
- Power becomes conquerable.
- History becomes fixable.

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Why This Story Can Only Be Told This Way (continued)

But this story argues the opposite:

- That systems absorb disruption.
- That violence can be quiet and procedural.
- That truth does not always liberate -- it often burdens.

The time loop is not a puzzle to solve -- it's a pressure mechanism.

The non-human intelligence is not a savior -- it's a mirror.

The ending cannot be triumphant, because triumph would be dishonest. This film must end with containment, because containment is the point. Any louder, flashier, or more reassuring version of this story would flatten it into genre comfort. This version insists on moral adulthood, asking the audience to sit with unresolved knowledge rather than escape it.

Why Now

- Growing public discourse around UAP/NHI.
- Whistleblower fatigue and institutional mistrust.
- Cultural tension between transparency and stability.
- Fear not of NHI (aliens), but of what systems do with discovery.

Rachel's Loop reframes disclosure as an ethical burden rather than a heroic act.

Bios

Screenwriter/Producer/Director: *J.T. Gurzi*



J.T. Gurzi is a third-generation Italian American born in the American Southwest and raised in the eastern Sierra Nevada Mountains, USA. He more notably co-created and produced the documentary *Heaven Adores You* (Universal/Mercury Studios) – an intimate and meditative inquiry into the life and music of Elliott Smith. His work has screened at AFI DOCS, CPH:DOX, IDFA, Melbourne, Slamdance, Tribeca, and hundreds of festivals worldwide. He was a Panavision New Filmmaker Program recipient for his directorial debut and graduate of the UCLA School of Theater, Film & Television MFA Screenwriting program. His below-the-line credits include Academy Award-winning films and Emmy Award-winning shows. He has a rapt passion for fringe underdogs and is currently developing a boutique slate of projects.

